



BY **INDRANI BAGCHI**
CEO, Ananta Centre

+

“I don’t want you to even inadvertently give the impression that we are purely and unsentimentally transactional. We are not”

BEST CEOs

S. JAISHANKAR
IMPACT ICON OF THE YEAR

RESHAPING INDIA’S PLACE IN THE WORLD

In many ways, Jaishankar explains Modi to the world. That’s no small feat

W

WE HAVE A litany of “Jaishankar-isms” — some home truths, others policy statements, some grand sweeps of geopolitics, others snarky, disarmingly delivered. Do you want to push back against western pressure on Russia? There are some choice remarks of our foreign minister you can rattle off, some which I heard quoted back at me at the recent Munich Security

Conference. Can you conflate India’s diplomatic choices today with its civilisational culture? Certainly, when you consider that the most adroit diplomats of the ancient world may well have been Lord Krishna and Hanuman.

But beneath his sharp policy acumen lies a deeper commitment to reshaping India’s place in the world, blending ancient wisdom with modern diplomacy.

TRUSTED LIEUTENANT

Jaishankar, I have argued earlier, has been Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s most inspired pick. He reflects a blend of academic rigour, extensive field experience, and a forward-looking approach to India’s foreign policy challenges, making him a key figure in contemporary international diplo-